

Teacher Guide — primary / module-03-ayurveda-good-health

IKS Curriculum

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Overview

Module 3 — Three Friends in Your Body (Ayurveda)

Age band: Primary · **Grades:** 3–5 · **Duration:** 10 sessions × 30 min

What children will learn

Three friends live in everyone’s body:

- **Vāta** — wind friend (quick, talkative, sometimes fidgety)
- **Pitta** — fire friend (sharp, focused, sometimes a bit fiery)
- **Kapha** — water/earth friend (calm, slow, steady)

Plus 3 healthy-habit ideas: **sleep on time, eat the right way, move every day.**

How this module sounds

- Story-led. The three friends have personalities.
- Drawing every day. Children GIVE their friends names and faces.
- One Sanskrit word per friend, repeated daily.

NEP 2020 alignment

- §4.6 (IKS) · §4.31 (well-being)

Materials

- 3 picture cards (wind, fire, water/clouds)
- Drawing paper, crayons
- A “three friends” wall poster

Day-by-day

Day	Title
1	Three Friends Story

Day	Title
2	Vāta — Wind Friend
3	Pitta — Fire Friend
4	Kapha — Water Friend
5	Friend Song + check-in
6	When Friends Rest (sleep)
7	What Friends Eat (food)
8	Project Day 1 — make your friends
9	Project Day 2 — finish + practise
10	Show & Tell

Safety

Nothing in this module is medical advice. If your child is unwell or has a condition, doctor first, always.

Project

Each child creates their THREE friends — drawings or models with personalities and names — and shows them on Day 10. Sticker for everyone.

10-Day Lesson Plan

Module 3 (Primary) — 10-Day Lesson Plan

Day	Title
1	Three Friends Story
2	Vāta — Wind Friend
3	Pitta — Fire Friend
4	Kapha — Water Friend
5	Song + check-in
6	When Friends Rest
7	What Friends Eat
8	Project Day 1
9	Project Day 2
10	Show & Tell

Daily structure (30 min)

Time	What
3 min	Settle + chant

Time	What
10 min	Story / new content
12 min	Drawing
5 min	Sharing

Daily chant

“Vāta, Pitta, Kapha — three friends inside me!”

What children leave with

- 3 friends named
- A drawing of their friends with personalities
- 3 healthy-habit ideas: sleep on time, eat well, move every day

Teacher Notes

Teacher Notes — Module 3 (Primary)

Tone

Three friends with personalities. Not types. Not labels. Not medicine.

Hard rule

Never imply your child IS a Vāta type / has a Pitta imbalance / etc. The three friends are everyone’s friends.

If a child says “my mum says I have Pitta,” gently redirect: “Yes! And you have Vāta and Kapha too. They’re all your friends.”

Common things to handle

- **“My friend has bad behaviour because their Pitta is angry.”** Reframe: friends are NOT labels. We don’t blame our friends or each other.
- **“My grandma uses Ayurveda for my cough.”** Celebrate. *“Your family knows the friends well.”*

Safety

No herbs without parent confirmation of no allergies. No food samples. No medical advice in any form.

If you only have 6 days

- Day 1: Story + Vāta
- Day 2: Pitta + Kapha

- Day 3: Song
- Day 4: Sleep + food (combined)
- Day 5: Project
- Day 6: Show & Tell

Sources

Sources — Module 3 (Primary)

Teacher reference only.

- Ayurveda framework: see Middle Module 3 `sources.md` for full citations.
- Story tone for the “three friends” framing is original to this curriculum.

Day 1 — Three Friends Story

Module: Three Friends (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Children meet all three friends (Vāta, Pitta, Kapha) through a story.

Materials

- 3 picture cards (wind blowing leaves; sun/candle; water/clouds)
- Drawing paper

Flow

Settle + chant intro (5 min)

Teach: “*Vāta, Pitta, Kapha — three friends inside me!*”

3 times, with claps.

Story (10 min)

“Inside every body — yours, mine, your grandma’s — live THREE FRIENDS. They’ve been there since you were born. Today we meet them.”

Show each card with a story:

Vāta — Wind Friend. “*Vāta is the wind friend. She makes things move inside you — your breath, your heartbeat, your thoughts. People with lots of Vāta are quick and talkative. Sometimes they fidget a lot.*”

Pitta — Fire Friend. *“Pitta is the fire friend. He helps your food become energy. People with lots of Pitta are sharp and focused. Sometimes they get a bit fiery (angry).”*

Kapha — Water Friend. *“Kapha is the water-and-earth friend. She makes you strong and steady. People with lots of Kapha are calm and patient. Sometimes they’re a bit slow.”*

“Important: we ALL have ALL THREE friends. Nobody has just one. Sometimes one friend is louder than the others — that’s normal!”

Drawing (12 min)

Each child draws their THREE friends — with faces, names, anything they like!

Show + chant (3 min)

2 children share. Chant to close.

Homework

- Tell a family member about the three friends. Ask them which friend they think is loudest in YOU today.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Draw all 3 friends doing something together.
- **Tier down:** Draw one favourite friend.

Day 2 — Vāta, the Wind Friend

Module: Three Friends (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Children explore Vāta through movement and a game.

Materials

- Open space
- Drawing paper

Flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Story (5 min)

“Today: meet Vāta — the WIND friend. Vāta makes things MOVE in your body.”

“What does Vāta do?” - Your breath in and out — Vāta. - Your heart beating — Vāta. - Your hand waving — Vāta. - Your thoughts moving — Vāta.

Vāta game (15 min)

Movement game. Three rounds: 1. *Wind round*: run around the room like the wind for 30 seconds. 2. *Quick-turn round*: stop and change direction every 5 seconds. 3. *Breath round*: sit. Breathe FAST 10 times. (How does your body feel? Vāta is awake.)

Then settle. “*That was your Vāta friend being LOUD. When Vāta is loud, we feel quick, talkative, sometimes worried.*”

“*To calm Vāta: SLOW breath. Warm food. Sit still. Hug something soft.*”

Drawing (5 min)

Draw your Vāta friend doing something quick.

Show + chant (2 min)

Homework

- Notice tonight: when does YOUR Vāta seem loud? (Before sleep? When excited?)

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Try the “calm Vāta” practices tonight before bed.
- **Tier down:** Just remember: Vāta = wind = movement.

Day 3 — Pitta, the Fire Friend

Module: Three Friends (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Children explore Pitta through warmth observation and stories.

Materials

- A warm tube light or sunny window
- Drawing paper

Flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Story (8 min)

“*Today: Pitta — the FIRE friend. Pitta is hot. Pitta helps cook your food inside you.*”

“*What does Pitta do?*” - Helps you digest lunch. - Gives you energy. - Makes your eyes see colours.

“When Pitta is loud, you feel SHARP and FOCUSED. You can finish things. You’re determined.”

“When Pitta is TOO loud, you feel ANGRY or HUNGRY or HOT. Sometimes you snap at your friends.”

Feel-the-fire activity (12 min)

- Stand at a sunny window or under a tube light.
- Hold your hand out. *“Feel the warmth? That’s Pitta-like — outside warmth.”*
- Touch your tummy. *“What’s happening in here? Pitta is working on your lunch.”*
- Touch your eyes (carefully). *“What do you see right now? Pitta makes seeing possible.”*

“To calm Pitta when it’s too loud: cool water. Take a walk. Talk to a friend. Don’t skip meals.”

Drawing (5 min)

Draw your Pitta friend doing something focused.

Show + chant (2 min)

Homework

- Notice tomorrow: when does YOUR Pitta seem loud? (When hungry? When focused?)

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Try this: when you feel a bit angry tomorrow, drink water FIRST. Note what changes.
- **Tier down:** Remember: Pitta = fire = digestion + focus.

Day 4 — Kapha, the Water Friend

Module: Three Friends (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Children explore Kapha through stillness and a calming practice.

Materials

- A glass of water
- Drawing paper

Flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Story (8 min)

“Today: Kapha — the WATER-and-EARTH friend. Kapha makes you strong and steady.”

“What does Kapha do?” - Holds your bones together. - Makes your skin smooth. - Helps you feel calm.

“When Kapha is loud, you feel CALM, patient, steady. You’re a good friend who listens. You sleep well.”

“When Kapha is TOO loud, you feel sleepy, slow, or stuck. Sometimes you don’t want to get up.”

Be the water (12 min)

Show the glass of water. *“See how it’s still? That’s Kapha-like.”*

Stillness practice: - Sit cross-legged. Hands on knees. - Eyes closed (or lowered). - Be still for 1 minute. Count 10 breaths.

How did it feel? Most children find it harder than they expected.

“Kapha is steady but stillness isn’t always easy. You have to practise.”

“To wake up Kapha when it’s too sleepy: exercise. Bright light. Hot drink. Spicy food. A surprise dance party.”

Drawing (5 min)

Draw your Kapha friend doing something calm.

Show + chant (2 min)

Homework

- Notice: when do YOU feel most Kapha-like? (Morning? After a big meal? When happy?)

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Sit still for 2 minutes at home tonight.
- **Tier down:** Just remember: Kapha = water = calm + steady.

Day 5 — Friend Song + Daily Check-In

Module: Three Friends (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Children memorise the 3 friends via a song + learn the daily “which friend is loudest?” check-in.

Materials

- 3 picture cards

Flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Song (10 min)

Tune: “Twinkle Twinkle”:

Vāta, Pitta, Kapha three, Three good friends inside of me! Vāta is the wind that flies,
Pitta is the fire in my eyes, Kapha is the steady ground — All three friends in me are
found!

Sing 3 times. Add gestures (Vāta = wave arms; Pitta = touch tummy; Kapha = pat shoulders).

Daily check-in game (12 min)

Show each card. Ask: - “*WHICH friend feels loudest in you RIGHT NOW?*”

Each child whispers their answer to a partner.

Then: - “*WHICH friend felt loudest YESTERDAY at this time?*” - “*WHICH friend felt loudest THIS MORNING when you woke up?*”

Note out loud: “*The same friend isn’t always loudest. They change with the day. That’s normal.*”

Drawing (3 min)

Quick: write all 3 friend names on one page.

Show + chant + song (2 min)

Homework

- Sing the song with a parent tonight.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Make up verse 2.
- **Tier down:** Just sing along.

Day 6 — When Friends Rest (Sleep)

Module: Three Friends (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Children learn that the three friends need rest — and that sleep happens at certain times for a reason.

Materials

- Drawing paper

- Optional: a “clock face” drawn on the board

Flow

Settle + chant + song (5 min)

Story (10 min)

“Just like you have a bedtime, the three friends have rest times.”

“Pitta (fire friend) does her big work after you sleep — she fixes things inside your body while you rest. So if you sleep late, Pitta can’t do her work properly.”

“The friends like you to sleep BY 9 OR 10 at night, and wake UP with the sun.”

Sleep rules from the three friends: - Sleep at the same time every night (friends like routine). - Dim lights an hour before sleep (Pitta calms when it gets dark). - No big meal right before sleep (friends are busy digesting; can’t rest). - Quiet wind-down (Vāta needs settling).

Activity (10 min)

Each child draws their “best bedtime routine” in 4 panels: 1. After dinner 2. Brushing teeth 3. Quiet activity (reading, drawing) 4. Sleep

Show + chant (5 min)

- 2 children share their drawings.
- Chant + song.

Homework

- Try ONE bedtime rule tonight (dim lights early, OR no screens before bed, OR same time as last night). Note what happens.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Try 2 bedtime rules.
- **Tier down:** Just remember: sleep at the same time, before 10pm.

Day 7 — What Friends Eat (Food)

Module: Three Friends (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Children learn that the three friends have food preferences — and that variety matters.

Materials

- Drawing paper
- Optional: pictures of varied foods (rice, lemon, salt, chili, bitter gourd, banana)

Flow

Settle + chant + song (5 min)

Story (10 min)

“Each friend likes different foods!”

Vāta loves: warm food, smooth food, oily food. *Examples:* warm rice with ghee, soup, milk.

Pitta loves: cool food, sweet food (in good measure), not too spicy. *Examples:* fruit, milk, cucumber.

Kapha loves: light food, spicy food, less sweet. *Examples:* warm spice tea, ginger, vegetables.

“But we ALL have ALL THREE friends — so we need ALL kinds of food. A meal with VARIETY makes all three friends happy.”

The six tastes (introduce quickly): - Sweet (sweet rice) - Sour (lemon) - Salty (salt) - Spicy/pungent (ginger) - Bitter (bitter gourd, neem) - Astringent (banana skin, beans)

“A traditional Indian thali has ALL six tastes — that’s clever cooking!”

Activity (10 min)

Each child draws a “balanced plate” with examples of as many tastes as they can include.

Show + chant (5 min)

Homework

- At dinner tonight, count how many of the 6 tastes are on your plate. Tell us tomorrow.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Make a “thali” drawing with 6 sections.
- **Tier down:** Just remember: variety on your plate makes the friends happy.

Day 8 — Project Day 1: Make Your Friends

Module: Three Friends (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Each child makes their three friends with names, faces, and personalities.

Materials

- Drawing paper / craft materials

Flow

Settle + chant + song (5 min)

Project (22 min)

Each child: - Draws their 3 friends (Vāta, Pitta, Kapha) on a SINGLE page. - Gives each friend a NAME (any name — “Tornado,” “Sparky,” “Bumblebee,” whatever). - Gives each friend a FACE. - Adds one thing each friend LIKES (e.g. Vāta = warm rice, Pitta = cucumber, Kapha = ginger tea).

Show + chant (3 min)

Homework

- Practise telling about your friends with a parent.

Day 9 — Project Day 2: Finish + Practise

Module: Three Friends (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Flow

Settle + chant + song (5 min)

Finish (15 min)

Children complete their three-friends project.

Buddy practise (8 min)

In pairs: each child tells about their friends for 30 seconds.

Show + chant (2 min)

Homework

- Practise telling once more. Bring everything tomorrow.

Day 10 — Show & Tell

Module: Three Friends (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Each child shows their three friends. Sticker for all.

Flow

Settle + chant + song (5 min)

Biggest chant + song yet!

Show & Tell (22 min)

- 1 child at a time. 30 seconds. Chime.
- Each child:
 1. Names their three friends.
 2. Tells one thing each friend likes.
 3. Says which friend is usually loudest in them.

Sticker for all.

Closing (3 min)

- Sing the song one last time.
- *“Your three friends are with you for life. Take care of them.”*

Homework

- None. Module done.

Oral Recall — Module 3 (Primary)

No paper tests.

Day 5 song check

Class chorus the 3 friend names.

Day 7 food check

“Name something Vāta loves.” (warm rice) *“Pitta?”* (cucumber, sweet fruit) *“Kapha?”* (ginger, spicy food)

Day 10 = automatic sticker for show-and-tell.

Activity 01 — Which Friend Is Loudest?

Module: Three Friends (Primary) · **Reusable** · **Time:** 5 min

Goal

Children practise the daily “check-in” with their three friends.

Instructions

Stand in a circle.

Teacher calls one of these scenarios. Children point to a card (or say): which friend is loudest?

1. “*You’re running to school and are late.*” (Vāta!)
2. “*You’re hungry and lunch isn’t ready.*” (Pitta!)
3. “*You’re snuggled under a blanket on a rainy day.*” (Kapha!)
4. “*You’re focused on a puzzle.*” (Pitta!)
5. “*You can’t sit still.*” (Vāta!)
6. “*You’re falling asleep listening to a story.*” (Kapha!)
7. “*You’re talking really fast.*” (Vāta!)
8. “*You feel calm and patient.*” (Kapha!)

Discussion

- Did you ever feel TWO friends loud at the same time?
- Has the loudest friend changed today?

Project Brief

Project — Module 3 (Primary)

What you’ll make

Draw your THREE friends — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha — on one page.

For each: - A name (you choose!) - A face - One thing they like to eat - One thing that makes them happy

Schedule

- Day 7: think about your friends.
- Day 8: draw.
- Day 9: finish + practise.
- Day 10: Show & Tell, 30 seconds.

Stars

- ★ You named your friends
- ★★ You drew all three
- ★★★ You said which is usually loudest in YOU

Sticker for all.